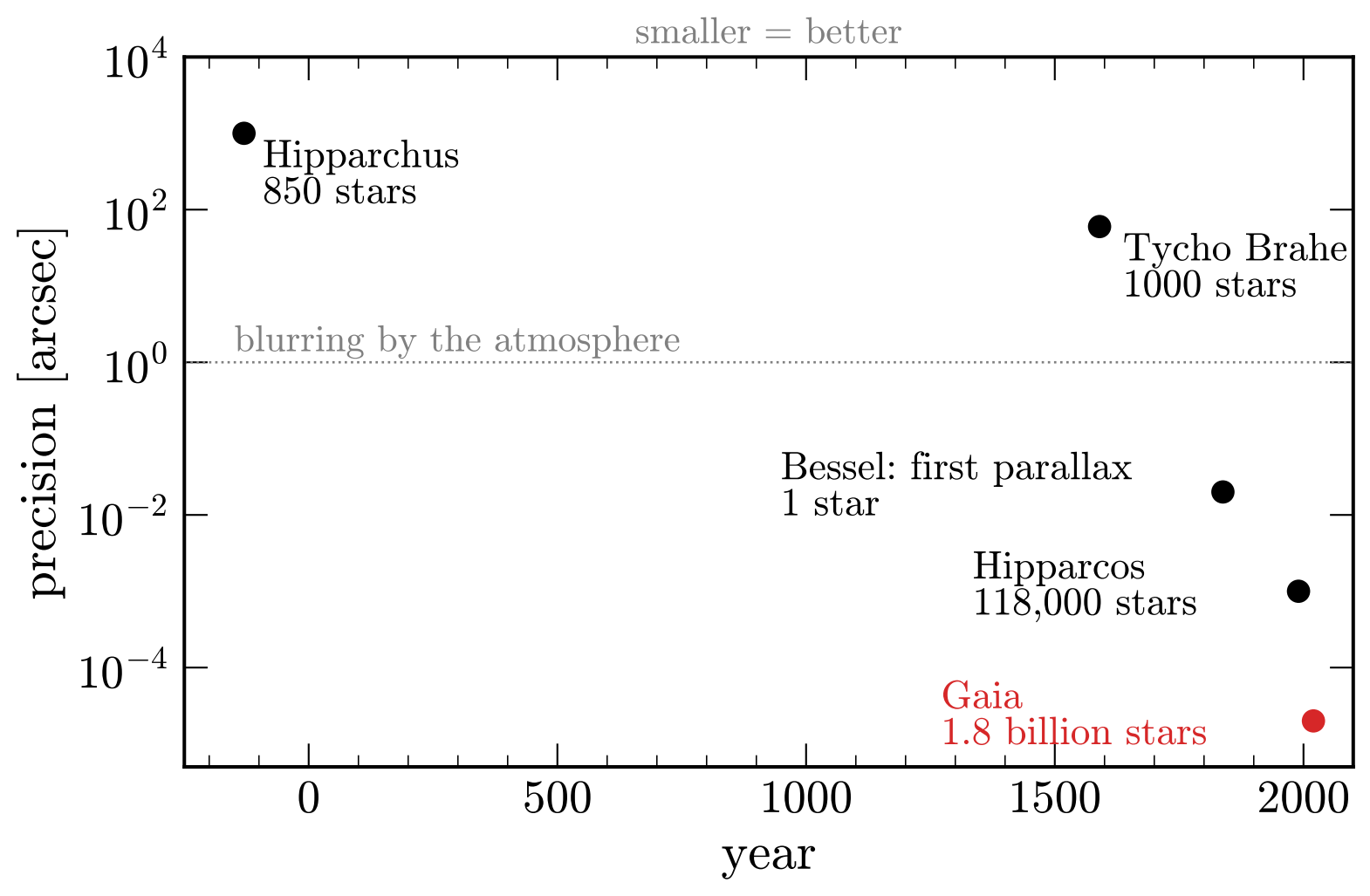
smaller = better
precision [arcsec]
10^4
10^2
10^0
10^{-2}
10^{-4}
Hipparchus
850 stars
Tycho Brahe
1000 stars
blurring by the atmosphere
Bessel: first parallax
1 star
Hipparcos
118,000 stars
Gaia
1.8 billion stars
0
500
1000
1500
2000
year